

# Student Entrepreneurship and Innovation Policy — Main Policy

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This main policy gives effect to Student Entrepreneurship and Innovation Policy and covers the purposes, responsibilities and operating expectations associated with Entrepreneurship. It should be read alongside supporting guidance and any subsequent circulars.

## Context and Background

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Entrepreneurship as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present main policy responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

The policy landscape has evolved considerably in recent years, and institutions under Higher Education Department have responded with renewed attention to Entrepreneurship, Startups, Innovation. This main policy provides the framework needed to guide consistent practice across the sector.

## Object and Purpose

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Entrepreneurship, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Startups across the system.

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Entrepreneurship, Startups across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

## Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Entrepreneurship, Startups, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

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## **Coverage**

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Entrepreneurship within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

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## **Key Provisions**

Institutions are required to integrate Entrepreneurship, Startups into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Entrepreneurship, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Startups.

## **Implementation Framework**

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Higher Education Department in line with the prescribed cycle.

## **Roles and Responsibilities**

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Entrepreneurship, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Higher Education Department acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

## **Monitoring Arrangements**

Higher Education Department will review implementation against agreed indicators, publish consolidated outcomes, and engage institutions that require additional support or show exemplary practice.

## **Conclusion**

The success of this policy rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Entrepreneurship and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.